

At the edge of a quiet forest, hidden beneath a canopy of ferns, lived a small green frog named Moss. His pond was no larger than a dining table, but to Moss it was an entire world. Dragonflies skimmed across its surface, beetles disappeared beneath fallen leaves, and every evening the setting sun turned the water golden.

That summer, however, the rain stopped.

Day by day, the pond grew smaller. The muddy shoreline crept inward, and the dragonflies disappeared. The other frogs eventually left in search of deeper water, but Moss stayed behind.

"My home knows I'm still here," he told himself. "The rain will come."

Weeks passed. Soon, only a shallow puddle remained beneath the largest fern. Moss spent his days in its shade, listening to the dry leaves rustling around him. Sometimes he wondered whether the others had been right to leave.

Then, one evening, something changed.

The forest became strangely still. The birds stopped singing, and a cool wind moved between the trees. Moss lifted his head.

A drop of water landed directly between his eyes.

Then another.

Within seconds, rain crashed through the canopy. Moss leapt from beneath the fern and danced through the mud as water poured into the empty pond. He jumped, splashed, and croaked so loudly that his voice echoed between the trees.

By morning, the pond was full again.

A few days later, the other frogs returned. They found Moss sitting proudly on his favorite stone as though nothing had happened.

"You really stayed here the whole time?" one asked.

Moss looked across the sparkling water.

"Of course," he said.

But secretly, he knew he had almost left too.

And perhaps that was what made staying matter.